

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 987

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate J. Clyde Edwards on the celebration of his ninety-fifth birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, J. Clyde Edwards celebrates his ninety-fifth birthday on March 25, 2026, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards has lived an amazing life and has experienced firsthand the breadth and span of American history; and

WHEREAS, Clyde Edwards was born in Selma, Alabama, and is one of nine siblings; he married his sweetheart, Jean, in 1950; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards served in the army during the Korean War; he was deployed on March 13, 1951, and was initially stationed in Seattle, Washington, prior to his company moving to Japan for three weeks before finally receiving orders to serve on the front line in Korea; and

WHEREAS, Clyde Edwards remained with his company on the front line until late September 1952, when they were called to rest and regroup while waiting for more reinforcements; once reinforcements arrived, they were moved to an island off the coast of Korea to guard Korean prisoners; and

WHEREAS, in March 1953, Mr. Edwards was ordered to Fort Sill and honorably discharged; he was recently awarded the Ambassador of Peace medal from the South Korean government for his service; and

WHEREAS, Clyde Edwards came home to Selma and started a job at Sears & Roebuck; later that year, he and his family moved to Chattanooga, where he secured a job with Southern Rail; and

WHEREAS, in November 1955, Mr. Edwards began working at Combustion Engineering; through hard work and dedication, he moved his way up from drill press operator to layout and design, to process engineering, and, ultimately, ended up as the manager of the purchasing department, from which position he retired in 1986; and

WHEREAS, his wife passed away in February 2018; today, Clyde Edwards lives and works on his small farm in Soddy Daisy; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards especially enjoys being around people, playing with his great-grandchildren, worshipping at his church, working on his tractor, and playing cards and bingo at the Soddy Daisy senior center; and

WHEREAS, Clyde Edwards has been an important member of the Shriners organization for many years; his service with the organization includes driving a bus of injured children and their families to hospitals and volunteering at various Shriners events to hand out socks and other items to children in need; and

WHEREAS, he is also passionate about politics; he drove tour buses for various politicians and can be regularly found at Saturday breakfasts at local fire departments to voice his opinion to politicians; and

WHEREAS, according to Mr. Edwards, the key to a long life is bone-in pork chops and raisin pecan pie—his absolute favorite meal; and

WHEREAS, Clyde Edwards is a joy to be around and a blessing to all who have the good fortune of knowing him; and

WHEREAS, as Mr. Edwards marks his ninety-fifth birthday, he remains a beloved member of his community who is admired for his faith, integrity, and enthusiasm for life; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate J. Clyde Edwards on the celebration of his ninety-fifth birthday and extend to him our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.